NIKESH MANDAL

SOC Analyst (L1) | Incident Triage & Network Security

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

MCA graduate with a strong computer science foundation and hands-on exposure to network traffic analysis, log parsing, and security operations. Experienced in building automated forensic triage tools, inspecting packets, and analyzing threat indicators. Holds certifications in Cisco Networking Essentials and Ethical Hacking. Seeking a 24x7 SOC Analyst (L1) role to monitor SIEM alerts, perform incident triage, and support threat mitigation.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security Operations: Log Analysis, Alert Triage, Incident Response, Packet Inspection, Digital Forensics, False Positive Filtering, IOC Extraction

Protocols & Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, HTTP/HTTPS, SMTP (SPF, DKIM, DMARC), OSI Model, Port Scanning

Security Tools: Wireshark, Metasploit, Burp Suite, Kali Linux, Nmap, Sysinternals, Linux CLI

SIEM & Lab Monitoring: Splunk, Wazuh (Homelab), Suricata

Programming & Automation: Python (Regex, Log Parsing, APIs), SQL, Bash, REST APIs

Frameworks & Standards: MITRE ATT&CK, Cyber Kill Chain, OWASP Top 10

SECURITY & FORENSIC PROJECTS

LogForge: Automated Log Analysis & Forensic Tool — **Python, REST APIs, JSON, SQLite**

- Built a log parsing engine with **14 detection rules** to identify brute-force attacks, unauthorized access, and anomaly spikes.
- Implemented automated extraction for IPs, timestamps, and error patterns, cutting down manual log triage time.
- Engineered search filters and CSV/JSON export capabilities for incident evidence logging and audit readiness.

Automated Phishing Header Parser & IOC Extractor — **Python, FastAPI**

- Developed a security tool to inspect raw `.eml` headers, validating **SPF, DKIM, and DMARC** records to identify spoofed senders.
- Automated extraction and defanging of malicious URLs, IPs, domains, and file hashes to speed up L1 triage workflows.

Browser Forensics & Investigation Tool — **Python, HTML, Data Visualization**

- Engineered a local artifact analysis tool to parse and reconstruct browser activity, cache entries, and download timelines.
- Designed an investigation dashboard to visualize activity history and identify potential initial infection vectors.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Analyst – AI / Data Operations — **Jan 2026 – Jun 2026**

Innodata (Remote) — *Remote*

- Validated large-scale data points against strict quality benchmarks, applying anomaly identification logic critical for false-positive reduction.

Cybersecurity Analyst Intern — **Jul 2025 – Dec 2025**

Virtual Cyber Labs, Delhi — *Delhi, India*

- Conducted packet-level inspection using **Wireshark** to analyze protocol behavior, TCP handshakes, and network traffic anomalies.
- Performed vulnerability assessments and lab exploits using **Kali Linux, Nmap, Metasploit, and Burp Suite**.
- Compiled technical security reports documenting identified vulnerabilities and basic remediation procedures.

System Operations Analyst (EDI) — **Sep 2024 – Apr 2025**

Vensure – Epay, Noida — *Noida, India*

- Monitored data pipelines and system operational logs following Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) to maintain pipeline reliability.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Master of Computer Applications (MCA) — Amity University, UP — **CGPA: 8.45 | 2022 – 2024**

B.Sc. in Computer Science — Rizvi College, Mumbai University — **CGPA: 7.91 | 2019 – 2022**

Certifications: Networking Essentials (Cisco Networking Academy) | Introduction to Ethical Hacking (Great Learning)